Phishing Email Analysis: Fake Visa World Cup Prize

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Summary

This phishing email impersonates Visa and offers a R$100,000 prize tied to the 2026 World Cup. The sender address is not a Visa address, replies are redirected to a different address, and the message was sent through a bulk mailing tool from a rented hosting server in London. The embedded link points to a random Google Cloud Run subdomain and carries the recipient's email address in the URL, a common victim-tracking technique. The page returned HTTP 404 at analysis time, and 1 of 93 VirusTotal vendors flagged the URL as phishing.

Verdict: Malicious (phishing, prize scam impersonating Visa).

Scope and safety

- Public sample from the Phishing Pot dataset (https://github.com/rf-peixoto/phishing_pot). No employer or personal data was used.
- Static analysis only. The email was read as plain text, and the link and IP were checked through third-party reputation services. No links were visited.

Email details

Field	Value	Why it matters
Subject	Copa 2026: Oportunidade de prêmio no valor de R$ 100.000,00, ID: 152092200	Portuguese. Translation: World Cup 2026: prize opportunity worth R$100,000.00. A prize plus an ID number is bait that looks official.
From	Visa, nao-responder-Visa701035750 @promocoes701035750	Display name claims Visa, but the address is not a Visa address. As captured, it has no valid domain ending (this may reflect dataset anonymization).
Return-Path	Same as From	Confirms the real sending address is not Visa.
Reply-To	suporte@notificacoes	Replies would go to a different address than the sender.
List-Unsubscribe	mailto:unsubscribe@notificacoes	Uses the same non-Visa naming.

Field	Value	Why it matters
X-Mailer	Custom Mailer v1.0	A homemade bulk-mailing tool, not an enterprise mail system.
X-Sender-IP	95.179.194.86	The server that actually sent the email.
Date	Mon, 6 Jul 2026 07:27:17 +0000	Send time.
Content-Type	text/html, quoted-printable	HTML body. Links appear encoded (=3D, line-wrap = signs) and must be cleaned before analysis.

The long X-MS-... headers were added by the Microsoft 365 mailbox that received the email. They are not part of the attack.

Timeline

1. **6 Jul 2026, 07:27 UTC:** Email sent from a rented server (Vultr, London) and received by a Microsoft 365 mailbox.
2. **Recipient view:** Sender name shows Visa, with a Portuguese subject offering a prize and an ID number.
3. **Expected victim flow (inferred, since the page was down):** The recipient clicks the link, lands on a page hosted on Google Cloud Run, and is asked for personal or payment details.
4. **27 Oct 2026, 13:13 UTC:** URL analyzed in VirusTotal. The page returned HTTP 404 (inactive).

Analysis

1. Sender and header analysis

- **Brand mismatch:** The display name says Visa, but Return-Path and From use a non-Visa address.
- **Reply-To mismatch:** Replies go to suporte@notificacoes, not the sender address.
- **Bulk mailer:** X-Mailer shows Custom Mailer v1.0.

2. Message content

- **Bait:** A large prize linked to a popular event (the 2026 World Cup), with an ID number to appear official.
- **Targeting:** Portuguese-language content suggests Brazilian recipients.
- **Body text observations:** The message is an HTML email written in Portuguese that presents a R$100,000 World Cup 2026 prize opportunity under the Visa name, with an ID number (152092200) in the subject to make it look official. The body contains a link to a Google Cloud Run page, which carries the recipient’s email address in the URL. The message asks the recipient to follow this link, and no legitimate Visa domain appears in the sender, Reply-To, or link. The same offer-and-click pattern is typical of prize scams that harvest personal or payment details.

3. Link analysis

Cleaned URL (defanged):
`hxxps://cop4asojateosom0-1094100152898[.]us-central1[.]run[.]app/?cid=phishing@pot@hotmail[.]com`

- **Domain:** A random subdomain on run.app, Google Cloud Run's hosting domain, which anyone can use. It has no relation to Visa.
- **Victim tracking:** The cid parameter embeds an email address (anonymized in the dataset). Phishers use this to track clicks and sometimes pre-fill login forms.
- **VirusTotal:** 1 of 93 vendors flagged it (LevelBlue: Phishing). HTTP status 404, content type text/html, resolving to 34.143.78.2.

4. Sender infrastructure

- **IP:** 95.179.194.86, hostname 95.179.194.86.vultrusercontent.com.
- **Owner:** The Constant Company, LLC (AS20473), a data center and web hosting provider in London, UK.
- **AbuseIPDB:** 0% confidence score, not found in database. Disposable hosting often has no reports, so a clean score is not proof of safety.
- **Assessment:** A real Visa email would not originate from a rented VPS.

5. Email authentication

SPF, DKIM, and DMARC results were not reviewed in the captured headers. [If you find an Authentication-Results line, add it here.]

Indicators of compromise (defanged)

Type	Indicator	Context
URL	hxxps://cop4asojateosom0-1094100152898[.]us-central1[.]run[.]app/?cid=phishing@pot@hotmail[.]com	Phishing link
Domain	cop4asojateosom0-1094100152898[.]us-central1[.]run[.]app	Google Cloud Run subdomain
IP	34[.]143[.]78[.]2	Resolved IP of the link domain
IP	95[.]179[.]194[.]86	Sending server (Vultr, London)
Hostname	95[.]179[.]194[.]86[.]vultrusercontent[.]com	Sender reverse DNS
Sender	nao-responder-Visa701035750[at]promocoes701035750	Spoofed Visa sender
Reply-To	suporte[at]notificacoes	Reply redirect
Mailer	Custom Mailer v1.0	Bulk mailing tool
Subject ID	152092200	Campaign identifier in subject

MITRE ATT&CK mapping

Technique	ID	Evidence
Phishing: Spearphishing Link	T1566.002	Email delivers a link to a hosted page
Impersonation	T1656	Message poses as Visa
Acquire Infrastructure: Virtual Private Server	T1583.003	Email sent from a rented Vultr server

(Verify IDs against https://attack.mitre.org before publishing.)

Verdict and confidence

Malicious (phishing, prize scam). Confidence is high because several independent signals agree:

1. Brand impersonation with a non-Visa sender address
2. Prize bait with an official-looking ID
3. Reply-To differs from the sender
4. Bulk mailer tool in headers
5. Sent from rented hosting infrastructure
6. Link points to a random free-cloud subdomain with no brand match
7. Recipient address embedded in the URL for tracking
8. One vendor flagged the URL as phishing

Recommended response actions

1. Block the sender address, Reply-To address, and sending IP at the email gateway.
2. Block the link domain at the web proxy and DNS filter.
3. Search mailboxes for the same sender, subject pattern, and ID format, then purge matches.
4. If any user clicked: reset their credentials, revoke active sessions, review sign-in logs, and check for new MFA methods or mailbox rules.
5. Report the URL to Google Cloud abuse and Google Safe Browsing, and the sending IP to Vultr abuse.
6. Send a short user awareness notice about fake prize emails.
7. Detection idea: alert when a known brand appears in the display name but the Return-Path domain does not match.

Limitations

- The page was inactive (HTTP 404), so no page content or credential form was observed. The credential-harvesting purpose is inferred from the pattern.
- Only 1 of 93 vendors flagged the URL, so the verdict relies on the combined evidence rather than reputation alone.
- No dynamic analysis or sandboxing was performed.
- Email authentication results were not reviewed.

Tools used

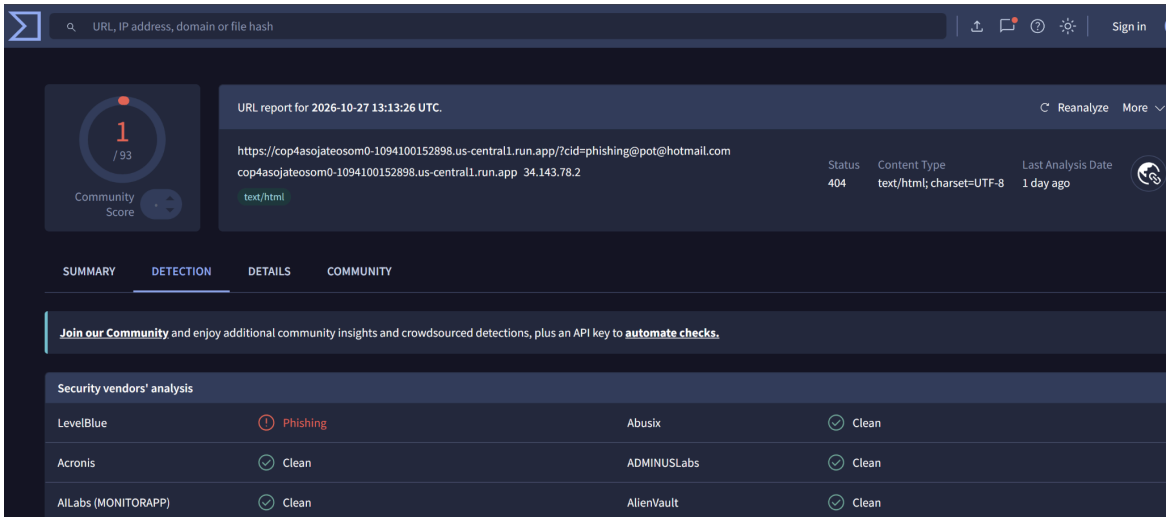
Tool	Purpose
Text view of .eml on GitHub	Header and body review
VirusTotal	URL reputation
AbuseIPDB	Sender IP reputation and ownership
MITRE ATT&CK	Technique mapping

Evidence (add before publishing)

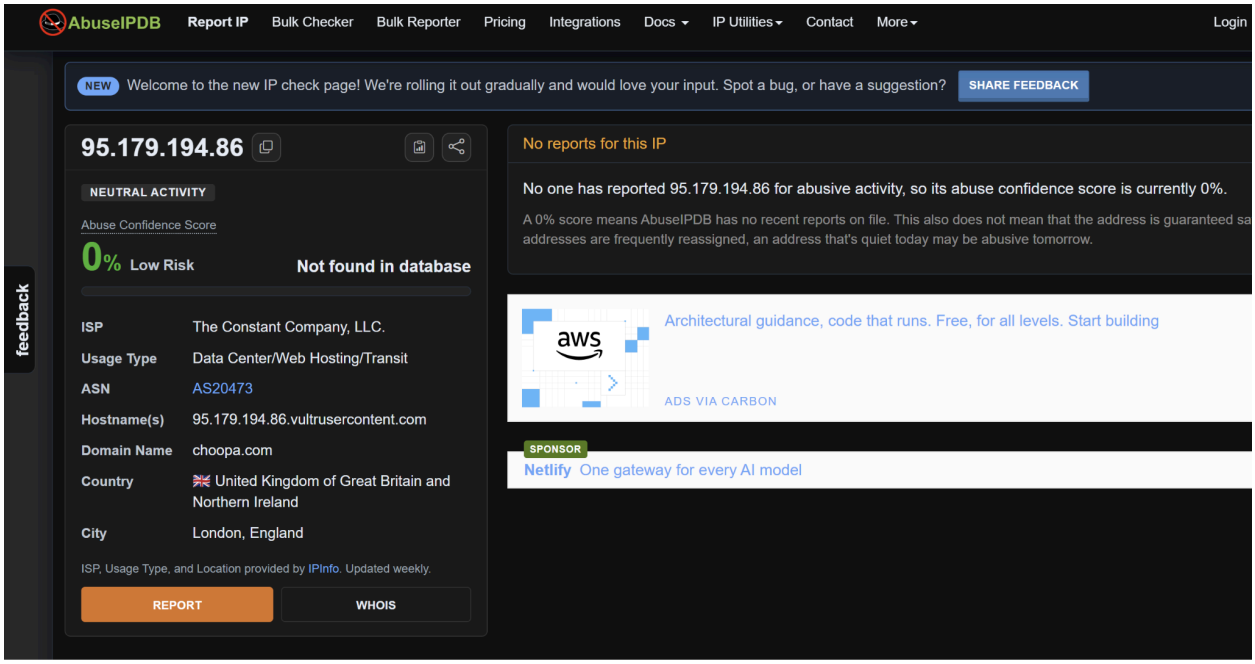
email headers (From, Return-Path, Reply-To, X-Mailer, X-Sender-IP)

```
From: Visa <nao-responder-Visa701035750@promocoes701035750>
To: <phishing@pot>
Subject: Copa 2026: Oportunidade de =?utf-8?q?pr=C3=AAmio?= no valor de R$
 100.000,00 =?utf-8?b?4oCU?= ID: 152092200
Content-Type: text/html; charset="utf-8"
Content-Transfer-Encoding: quoted-printable
Reply-To: suporte@notificacoes
List-Unsubscribe: <mailto:unsubscribe@notificacoes?subject=unsubscribe>
X-Mailer: Custom Mailer v1.0
X-IncomingHeaderCount: 9
Message-ID: <64d85485-866c-441a-a1f3-76d026d623d3@BL6PEPF0001AB74.namprd02.prod.outlook.com>
Return-Path: nao-responder-Visa701035750@promocoes701035750
Date: Mon, 6 Jul 2026 07:27:17 +0000
X-MS-Exchange-Organization-ExpirationStartTime: 06 Jul 2026 07:27:17.8055
 (UTC)
X-MS-Exchange-Organization-ExpirationStartTimeReason: OriginalSubmit
```

VirusTotal result (1/93, LevelBlue: Phishing, 404)



screenshot of AbuseIPDB results


AbuseIPDB
Report IP
Bulk Checker
Bulk Reporter
Pricing
Integrations
Docs
IP Utilities
Contact
More
Login
NEW
Welcome to the new IP check page! We're rolling it out gradually and would love your input. Spot a bug, or have a suggestion?
SHARE FEEDBACK
feedback
95.179.194.86
NEUTRAL ACTIVITY
Abuse Confidence Score
0% Low Risk
Not found in database
ISP
The Constant Company, LLC.
Usage Type
Data Center/Web Hosting/Transit
ASN
AS20473
Hostname(s)
95.179.194.86.vultrusercontent.com
Domain Name
choopa.com
Country
United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland
City
London, England
ISP, Usage Type, and Location provided by IPInfo. Updated weekly.
REPORT
WHOIS
No reports for this IP
No one has reported 95.179.194.86 for abusive activity, so its abuse confidence score is currently 0%.
A 0% score means AbuseIPDB has no recent reports on file. This also does not mean that the address is guaranteed sa
addresses are frequently reassigned, an address that's quiet today may be abusive tomorrow.
aws
Architectural guidance, code that runs. Free, for all levels. Start building
ADS VIA CARBON
SPONSOR
Netlify One gateway for every AI model